even jewellery and textiles. Tents and all other baggage and supplies were carried by bullock carts.

Adil Shah could only muster 120,000 infantry, 18,000 cavalry and 150 elephants, though he had better artillery. A brutal war followed in which Adil Shah was routed and fled for his life. Animosities among the Deccan Sultanates meant no one aided him. Vijayanagar's casualties were as high as 16,000. Their spoils of the war were 'four thousand horses of Ormuz, a hundred elephants, four hundred heavy cannons' and more. When the victorious king entered Raichur, writes Nuniz, its citizens greeted him 'with more cheerful countenances than their real feelings warranted', and many cried and begged him for mercy. Despite the king's admonition against it, his men indulged in 'great robberies' in the city. Indeed, soldiers looting a defeated city was a common practice on both sides, part of what we might call their 'package of incentives'. When Adil Shah sued for peace and implored the king to restore Raichur to him, Krishnadevaraya agreed to do so on one condition: Adil Shah must come and kiss his foot. Krishnadevaraya then marched to Bijapur, 'the best city in all the kingdom of Deccan' and 'left [it] almost in ruin'.

Interestingly, Krishnadevaraya, writes Nuniz, 'fell sick of the same illness of which all of his ancestors had died, with pains in the groin, of which die all the kings of Vijayanagar'. Given the sexually profligate ways of the kings, this sounds like venereal disease. The next king, Achyutaraya, also had some five hundred wives, mostly 'daughters of [governors] and nobles of the country'. Nuniz writes that all of these women would be burnt at the king's death but he doesn't comment on the political and social compulsions that led even powerful families to consign their daughters into such bargains.

King Achyutaraya, Nuniz says, 'never puts on any garment more than once', which are typically made of fine silk 'worked with gold'. In contrast to the sartorial tastes of the king and his courtiers, 'the common people go quite naked, with the exception of a piece of cloth about their middle', writes Ludovico di Varthema, an Italian traveller to Vijayanagar between 1502–08. Mosquitos are a menace, writes Nuniz, and the king 'always carries a mosquito net with a frame of silver'. He is so rich because all of the land belongs to him, and his regional governors are principally rent collectors. Near Dussehra time, according to Nuniz, they pay the king up to